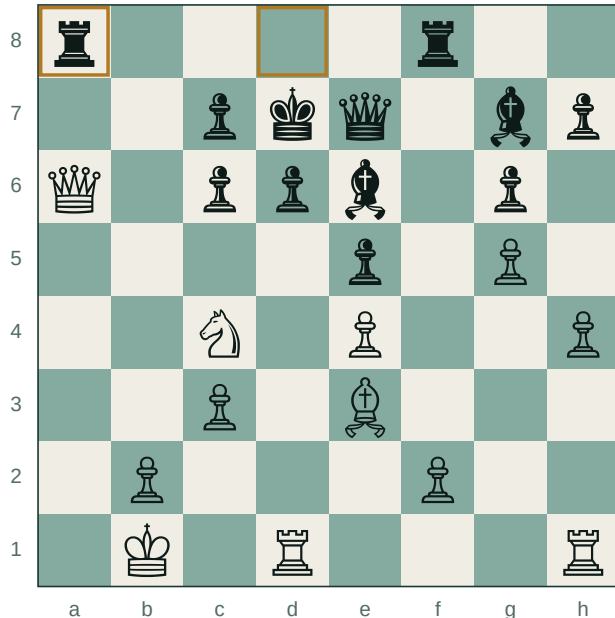


Interference tactics: White, move 25

Interference tactics

White to move



Previous move: 24...Ra8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

25. Nb6+ cxb6 26. Qb7+ Ke8 27. Qxa8+

25.Nb6+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. From b6 it attacks king on d7 and rook on a8. Recorded reply: **25...cxb6**.

26.Qb7+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From b7 it attacks king on d7 and rook on a8. Recorded reply: **26...Ke8**.

27.Qxa8+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on a8.

At the end, nominal material is White 28 / Black 26 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +2: the balance goes from +0 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on d7. Absolute pin: pawn on d6.